Either way, we make the attackers' job is

[11] Assuming `i < k`; otherwise, if `i > k`, we refer the subset $\{N_k, N_{k+1}, \ldots N_{i-1}, N_i\}$.

[12] JProfiler is a commercial tool; you can of course find open-source alternatives that will get the job done.

[13] The standard implementation of the remove method in BSTs, when the node `N` to remove has both children, uses the node's successor to replace the key to delete (and then recursively delete this successor). Over a long number of removals, this causes the tree to become skewed, left-leaning. A solution to mitigate this effect is randomly decide, with a 50% probability, to use the predecessor of a key instead of its successor.

[14] Stack overflow, its relation with recursion, and how to avoid such crashes is explained in appendix E.

[15] Assuming the algorithms are implemented verbatim, it's also not dependent on the specific implementation.

[16] "The real problem is that programmers have spent far too much time worrying about efficiency in the wrong places and at the wrong times; premature optimization is the root of all evil (or at least most of it) in programming.".
Knuth, Donald Ervin. The art of computer programming. Pearson Education, 1997.